



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

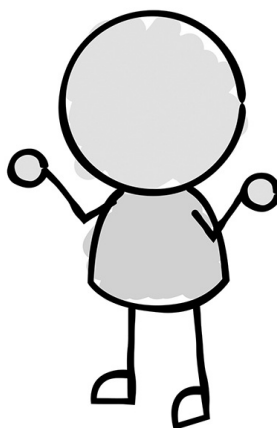
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Let's Start!

Nobody's perfect!



Learning Outcome

Describe past experiences in a range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- In six words, how can you describe your personality?
- Have you ever wanted to change anything about your personality?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about people's appearance and personality.
- I can discuss experiences I've had or haven't had.
- I can talk about habits in the past.





Let's Explore!

Peter talks about his date. Her **smile lights up the room***!

* When someone's "smile lights up the room", it means they have a very bright and attractive smile.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Peter: Hey, Frank.

Frank: Hey, Peter. How was the date? Have you ever seen such a killer smile before?

Peter: Yeah, you were right about her smile. It lights up the room!

Frank: She and I used to work together. She's a real firecracker!

Peter: You can say that again! She's very inquisitive ... I've never met someone who asked so many personal questions. She kind of annoyed me when she asked about my previous girlfriends.

Frank: Be realistic, man. Nobody's perfect.

Peter: Yeah, you're right. She's traveled a lot, which is cool.

Frank: Have you asked her about her cats? She has a lot of cats.

Peter: Uh ... no. But I recognized her car. I think I've seen it around town before.

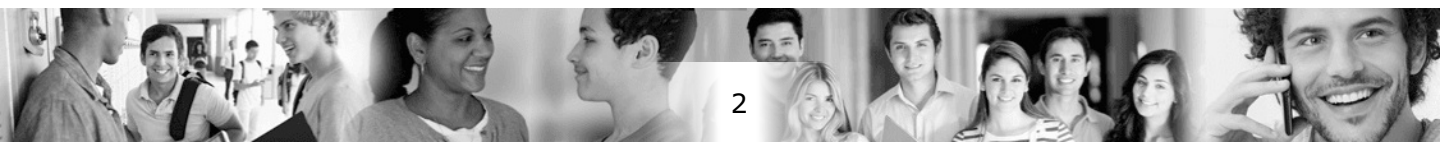
Frank: Yeah, it's very distinctive - like her! I used to see it around all the time, too.

Peter: I would always stop and do a double take when I saw it.

Frank: Yeah, there aren't too many pink polkadot cars out there!

Peter: We're going to see each other again, I think.

Frank: That's great man. Glad to hear it.





Let's Practice!

Did you hear what happened to me?

Instructions: Draw a line to match the sentences in Column A and Column B.

COLUMN A

1. Have you ever seen
2. I've never met someone
3. She's traveled
4. I think I've seen it
5. We've made plans

COLUMN B

- a. who asked so many personal questions.
- b. around town before.
- c. a lot, which is cool.
- d. to see each other again.
- e. such a killer smile before?



Let's Practice!

Do you want to know more about Tracy?

Instructions: Choose the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the conversation.

Word bank

inquisitive / lights / distinctive / firecracker / annoyed

1. Her smile _____ up the room!
2. She's a real _____ !
3. She's very _____ .
4. She kind of _____ me when she asked about my previous girlfriends.
5. Yeah, her car is _____, like her!
very





Extension Activity

Talking to a stranger about your past can be easy.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a short story about your experiences in your past. (2-3 sentences)
- Introduce yourself to a partner and read your story.
- Listen to your partner share their story.
- Talk about the similarities and differences between your experiences.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I can write a story in 2-3 sentences about things in my past.

☐ ☐

I can introduce myself to a stranger.

☐ ☐

I can share my story with the stranger.

☐ ☐

I can listen to and talk to the stranger about their story.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- inquisitive** (adjective): asking questions because you want to know or learn more
e.g. Martin was inquisitive, always asking questions.
- realistic** (adjective): being able to see things as they really are and to deal with them in a practical way
e.g. Sarah had realistic plans for her future.
- to recognize** (verb): to know and remember someone or something because you have seen it before
e.g. He knew it was her because he recognized her face.
- to annoy** (verb): to make someone to feel slightly angry
e.g. He asked so many questions it started to annoy people.
- firecracker** (noun): someone with a lot of energy and personality
e.g. She's a real firecracker!
- to do a double take** (expression): to look at something twice because you are shocked at what you saw
e.g. I would always stop and do a double take when I saw it.
- distinctive** (adjective): obviously different from others
e.g. Her personality is very distinctive.





Learning Points

Present Perfect vs. The Simple Past tense

The **Present Perfect** is for unfinished actions.

Present Perfect example	Meaning
<i>Peter has just talked to his date on the phone.</i>	(Peter just did it and he still has his phone in his hands)
<i>Frank has woken up.</i>	(He is yawning and might not be standing up or he is still in bed)

The **Simple Past** is for completed and finished actions.

Simple Past example	Meaning
<i>Peter talked to his date on the phone this morning.</i>	(He did it a while ago, now he is doing something else)
<i>Frank woke up early today.</i>	(He took a shower and he is dressed now)

Used to and Would to Talk About Past Habits

Would and **used to** have rather similar meanings. They are both used to describe something that happened regularly in the past but doesn't happen any longer.

However, there is an important difference between **used to** and **would**.

Would is not used unless you know that the time frame is in the past, while **used to** does not require this. Read the following example: *We used to visit India.* (correct)

However, when **would** replaces **used to**, the same example becomes ungrammatical:

We would visit India. (not correct)

We would visit India every summer when we were children. (correct)

Examples:

- *I used to drink tea all the time.*
- *I would always stop at the tea shop after work.*
- *I would always stop and do a double take when I saw it.*

